

WRITING A SUMMARY

DOs and DON‘Ts

DOs
WHAT IS IMPORTANT?

- Read the text carefully and highlight any improtant information.
- Begin your summary with an introductory sentence which includes
  - author, type of text, publishing date, source (if applicable)
  - topic.
- Use your own words.
- Use the simple present tense.
- Focus on important aspects.
- Use formal language.
- Write about 1/4 to 1/3 of the origional text.

DON‘Ts

- Don‘t give your opinion
- Don‘t copy sentences from the text/ don‘t quote
- Don‘t analyse the text
- Don‘t use informal language
- Don‘t use the present progressive tense (e.g. The author is writing about….)
- Don‘t go into too much detail or include too many examples
- Don‘t re-narrate the text

NOW YOU!

Read the given text and write a summary.

vbs ----11BG-English----------Hahn/Wollmerstädt/Becker vbs

Going green: the final report by Julie Price

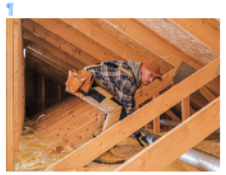


We started our 'green year' exactly twelve months ago – on January 1st last year. Now, we have finished, and it is time to look back on the experience.

Like a lot of people, Paul and I had already made ourselves a little greener. For example, we had started recycling more carefully, and we tried to reduce energy loss by turning off lights and heating when we weren't using them. But last year was a very different attempt, and this is how it all began.

As a journalist, I had written an article about home offices. One of the professors I interviewed asked me to turn off my modem and progress reports. Oh dear! My boss was not very pleased. After all, when a professor gives you information, you do not refuse.

So this is how it all began. First, we replaced all our light bulbs with energy-saving ones. Then, we set ourselves a limit: we would only spend a certain amount of money on energy each month. After that, we finally started saving both money and energy.



The next important thing to do was to put a wind turbine on the roof. Perhaps that was a bit strange: small wind turbines in big cities? But we had seen a similar wind turbine in Spain, so why not? Europeans seek other solutions, and it is clear energy costs are rising. In the end, we spent our limited budget on more roof insulation. This simple, sensible step has already paid for itself.

After we had done this, we faced our first hard decision. We loved our car, but we decided it had to go, as we had finally sold it. Living more slowly got easier. After all, we live in a city, so we could walk, cycle and use public transport. Sometimes it took longer, but we learned to allow more time. Our biggest wish was to move to the countryside, but we couldn't afford it. So we tried to finish double-glazing the windows.

The other difficult thing was the summer holiday. We had always enjoyed going somewhere warm as a family. Both my husband and I are hoping that our son will remember those lovely holidays at the seaside. So it was quite hard to tell him that we weren't going on holiday by plane this year. Instead, we stayed at home and made day trips. We saved a lot of money, but we also learned that it is possible to enjoy your free time without travelling far.

What about the future? Well, we're not sure if we'll live more 'greenly' than we do now. The final thing is that somehow we must find a way to travel the world again. ----------(454 words)

source: www.e-fundresearch.com